

IN Class 8 History — Our Pasts III

Modern India & the Freedom Struggle, 1750–1947 | UPSC CSE 2027

★ READ THIS FIRST — This Is The Book That Matters Most

Everything you have studied so far has been foundation. **This is the payload.**

ROUGH SHARE OF UPSC HISTORY MARKS

ANCIENT INDIA	####	(Class 6, 12-I)
MEDIEVAL INDIA	#####	(Class 7, 12-II)
MODERN INDIA & FREEDOM STRUGGLE	#####	(Class 8, 10, 12-III)

Modern India carries roughly 3–4x the weight of ancient and medieval COMBINED -- across Prelims AND Mains, and it is the **ONLY** period with a dedicated syllabus line in BOTH papers.

The Prelims syllabus says: *"History of India and **Indian National Movement**."* **The Mains GS1 syllabus devotes four separate lines to it**, including *"The Freedom Struggle — its various stages and important contributors/contributions from different parts of the country."*

⚠️ **If you have limited time, this book outranks Classes 6, 7, 9 and 11 put together.** Read it slowly and twice.

📖 The Whole Book on One Page

1757	1765	1793	1857	1885	1915	1947
v	v	v	v	v	v	v
+-----+	+-----+	+-----+	+-----+	+-----+	+-----+	+-----+
PLASSEY	DIWANI	PERMA-	THE	INDIAN	GANDHI	INDEPEN-
Company	of	NENT	REVOLT	NATIONAL	RETURNS	DENCE +
wins in	BENGAL	SETTLE-	Company	CONGRESS		PARTI-
Bengal	revenue	MENT	rule	founded	Champa-	TION
	rights		ENDS ->		ran ->	
			CROWN		Salt ->	
					Quit	
+-----+	+-----+	+-----+	+-----+	+-----+	+-----+	+-----+
Ch.2	Ch.2/3	Ch.3	Ch.5	Ch.8	Ch.8	Ch.8

Running through the whole period:

Ch.1 how we know | Ch.4 tribals | Ch.6 education | Ch.7 social reform

The three-part shape:

- Ch.2–3:** how a **trading company became a territorial ruler**, and how it extracted revenue
- Ch.4–7:** what colonial rule **did to Indian society** — tribals, the 1857 revolt, education, women and caste
- Ch.8:** how Indians **fought back and won**

Chapter Map

#	Chapter	Really about	UPSC Weight
01	Introduction: How, When and Where	Periodisation, James Mill , colonial sources and their silences	★ ★ ★
02	From Trade to Territory	How the Company conquered India — Plassey, Buxar, subsidiary alliance, Doctrine of Lapse	★ ★ ★ ★ ★
03	Ruling the Countryside	Permanent Settlement, Ryotwari, Mahalwari ; indigo and Champaran's prehistory	★ ★ ★ ★ ★
04	Tribals, Dikus and the Vision of a Golden Age	Forest laws, Birsa Munda	★ ★ ★ ★
05	When People Revolt: 1857 and After	The Revolt of 1857 and the transfer to the Crown	★ ★ ★ ★ ★
06	Civilising the "Native", Educating the Nation	Macaulay, Wood's Despatch , Gandhi and Tagore on education	★ ★ ★ ★
07	Women, Caste and Reform	Sati, widow remarriage, Phule, Ambedkar, Periyar	★ ★ ★ ★ ★
08	The Making of the National Movement	The entire freedom struggle, 1885–1947	★ ★ ★ ★ ★

Five Threads

1 Trade → revenue → territory

The Company came to **buy cloth and spices**. To buy, it needed silver. Then it discovered it could **take Bengal's revenue** and **buy Indian goods with Indian money**. **Chapter 2 and 3 are one continuous argument about that discovery.**

2 Every "reform" had a revenue motive underneath

Permanent Settlement, forest laws, the shift to commercial crops — all presented as improvement, all designed to **secure a predictable flow of revenue**. Learn to ask of every policy: *who paid, and who collected?*

3 Resistance was continuous, not occasional

Not just 1857. Santhal, Kol, Munda, indigo, Deccan riots, faqir and sanyasi rebellions — **the countryside was in revolt for a century before the Congress existed**. NCERT insists on this.

4 The colonial state classified in order to rule

Surveys, censuses, maps, ethnography. **Knowing India was a technique of governing it** — and the categories created (caste counts, "criminal tribes", "martial races") reshaped Indian society permanently.

5 Two nationalisms, and a partition

The movement was never one thing. **Moderates vs Extremists; Congress vs Muslim League; Gandhi's mass politics vs revolutionary action vs Ambedkar's separate demand**. Understanding **why it ended in Partition** requires taking all these strands seriously.

Suggested Pace — 12 days

Days	Chapters
1	Ch.1
2–3	Ch.2 — slow down
4–5	Ch.3 — slow down
6	Ch.4
7–8	Ch.5 (1857)
9	Ch.6
10	Ch.7
11–12	Ch.8 — the biggest chapter in the book
13	Revision + quiz

Progress Tracker

- ☐ Ch.1 — Introduction: How, When and Where
- ☐ Ch.2 — From Trade to Territory
- ☐ Ch.3 — Ruling the Countryside
- ☐ Ch.4 — Tribals, Dikus and the Vision of a Golden Age
- ☐ Ch.5 — When People Revolt: 1857 and After
- ☐ Ch.6 — Civilising the "Native", Educating the Nation
- ☐ Ch.7 — Women, Caste and Reform
- ☐ Ch.8 — The Making of the National Movement
- ☐ Full revision
- ☐ Quiz (target 85%+)

How Each Chapter Note Is Built

Same as Classes 6 and 7:  **Syllabus Classification** and  **Learning Outcomes** at the top, then the body with diagrams and tables, then  **UPSC Focus** (Prelims traps + Mains angles) →  Glossary →  Recap →  Practice questions.

Source: `../Textbook_PDF/Our_Pasts_III/` — NCERT, rationalised 8-chapter edition, read in full.  Note: the rationalised edition is **one book of 8 chapters**. The old "Part 2" no longer exists, so the `Class_08_Our_Pasts_III_Part2` folder is obsolete.